Buddhist stupa that carried an inscription saying the relics of the Buddha were made by his brethren, the Sakyas.[9] Structural portions of stupas have also emerged at Lauriya-Nandangarh, but their chronology is uncertain and they are likely to be later than Ashoka.[10] So, it appears that the early burial mounds were not Buddhist, but as the location attracted congregations for rituals and worship, a pillar in the neighbourhood was thought a good idea. Traders and travellers would in their passage have seen it and thought of halting, for it was positioned where the two principal routes leading to the Nepal terai met. The religious significance of such routes was evident to all, as borne out by Ashoka's pilgrimage and his building programme over the trail. The terai was fairly populous at the time, dotted with settlements, some of them fortified. Such routes emerge out of 'acts of consensual making', marked out by regular journeys across them over centuries, sometimes millennia.[11] Records of such journeys have enabled modern observers to make sense of objects such as ossuaries and relics along them, in this instance the objects observed being above ground in the shape of pillars.